GLP-1 Friendly Foods

What to eat while on Semaglutide or Tirzepatide — so you feel better, protect your muscle, and get the most from your program.

Why food choices matter more on a GLP-1. Your medication slows how quickly your stomach empties and turns down your appetite. You will eat less — so every bite needs to count. The right foods help prevent nausea, constipation, and muscle loss. The wrong foods are the most common reason patients feel sick on their medication.

Build every plate in this order

1. Protein first	Eat your protein before anything else on the plate. Aim for at least 1 gram of protein per pound of your goal body weight per day, spread across meals.
2. Vegetables & fiber	Fill the next part of the plate with non-starchy vegetables. Fiber supports regular bowel movements and keeps you full.
3. Smart carbs last	If you still have room, add a small portion of whole-food carbohydrates. Skip them if you are already satisfied.

Foods that work well

Lean proteins	Chicken or turkey breast, fish and shrimp, eggs and egg whites, lean ground turkey or beef (93% lean), tofu and tempeh, cottage cheese, plain Greek yogurt, protein shakes (20–30 g protein, low sugar).
Vegetables	Leafy greens, zucchini, green beans, cucumber, bell peppers, asparagus, cauliflower, mushrooms, tomatoes. Cooked vegetables are often easier on the stomach than raw in the first weeks.
Fruits	Berries, apples, pears, oranges, kiwi, melon. Choose whole fruit over juice.
Smart carbs	Oats, quinoa, sweet potato, beans and lentils, brown rice, whole-grain or high-fiber wraps and bread — in small portions.
Healthy fats	Avocado, olive oil, nuts and seeds, nut butter. Keep portions small — fat slows digestion further and can bring on nausea.
Fluids	Water first — half your body weight in ounces per day. Herbal tea, flavored still water, and electrolyte drinks without added sugar.

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Foods to limit

These are the foods most likely to cause nausea, bloating, reflux, or vomiting on a GLP-1:

- **Fried and greasy foods** — fast food, fries, fried chicken, heavy cream sauces
- **High-sugar foods and drinks** — soda, sweet tea, candy, pastries, sweetened coffee drinks
- **Carbonated drinks** — add pressure to a stomach that is already emptying slowly
- **Alcohol** — worsens nausea, adds empty calories, and can lower blood sugar
- **Large, heavy meals** — especially late at night
- **Very spicy foods** — can trigger reflux and stomach upset

How to eat on a GLP-1

- **Eat small portions.** Use a smaller plate. Start with half of what you used to eat.
- **Slow down.** Put your fork down between bites. It takes time for fullness to register.
- **Stop at satisfied, not full.** Overeating on a GLP-1 is the fastest way to feel sick.
- **Do not skip meals.** Low appetite is not a reason to go all day without eating — it leads to muscle loss and fatigue.
- **Sip water between meals,** not large amounts during meals.
- **Wait before lying down.** Stay upright for 2–3 hours after eating to reduce reflux.
- **Keep easy protein on hand** — Greek yogurt, string cheese, hard-boiled eggs, protein shakes — for days when appetite is very low.

A sample day

Breakfast	Plain Greek yogurt with berries and a sprinkle of chia seeds — or two eggs with sautéed spinach.
Lunch	Grilled chicken over mixed greens with cucumber, tomato, and a light olive oil dressing.
Snack	Cottage cheese with sliced apple, or a low-sugar protein shake.
Dinner	Baked salmon, roasted zucchini and green beans, and a small scoop of quinoa.

When to call us: nausea or vomiting that keeps you from eating or drinking, no bowel movement in 3 or more days despite your bowel regimen, or severe or persistent abdominal pain. **Call 911 if symptoms are severe.** This guide is general education — your provider guides your individual plan.

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